



Deutsch-lernen.com takes meticulous care of both the beginners as well as the advanced learners

complex sentences and their usage. They also have the international pen pal section that allows you to communicate in German with people across the world.

Similarly, www.businessspanish.com teaches you Spanish. It offers 520 lessons



Ourkarnataka.com stands out for the lucid technique it uses in teaching Sanskrit

a year. You receive a daily lesson once you sign up for their services. In addition, you are taught business related terms ranging from advertising to government. With the support of audio clips for pronunciation, you will be comfortable with Spanish in no time flat.

So you want to flatter that special someone by speaking the language of love, French. Check out www.france-pub.com. You can get grammar lessons based on real life situations, you can download

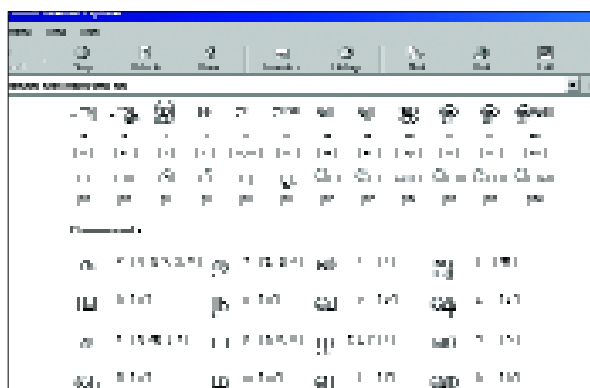
the lessons and listen to them. The chat rooms let you to talk in French, and help sharpen your linguistic skills. You can e-mail your homework in, and get feedback. Who said online lessons are not interactive?

Mera Bharat mahaan

India has 18 official languages, and is a linguist's delight. And yes, there are Web sites that promote Indian languages. Sanskrit, often called the mother of all languages, is on the verge of extinction in the very country it originated in. Visit www.ourkarnataka.com/learnsanskrit/sanskrit_main.htm to learn Sanskrit taught to you with English as your base language.

You can also learn the oldest South Indian language—Tamil. Just log on to <http://ccat.sas.upenn.edu/plc/tamilweb>. Promoted by the University of Pennsylvania, this is a funded programme that caters to students studying in American Universities. It has three levels of learning: Beginning from learning the alphabet and grammar; it goes on to show you Tamil radio plays and stories as an introduction to the Tamil literary culture.

The recently popular music video *Aika Dajiba* by singer Vaishali Samant has generated considerable interest in Marathi. Check out www.marathimitra.com



A glimpse of the Tamil alphabet, neatly laid out for easy learning



Sites to visit

Ancient Languages

Mel Gibson's movie, *The Passion of The Christ*, about the torture Jesus Christ went through in his last hours of life, has fuelled the desire in many, to learn languages of yore such as Aramaic, Hebrew, Latin, etc. Here are some sites that will do exactly that:

http://www.wannalearn.com/AcademicSubjects/World_Languages/Latin/

The Web site points you to places that will teach you how to use grammar, pronounce and converse in Latin.

<http://www.kypros.org/LearnGreek/>

Learn the language of the Gods—well Greek mythological gods at least. Read the fascinating tales of the Greek culture while you learn.

<http://perso.wanadoo.fr/babel-site>

You can learn obscure languages such as Occitan, used in the medieval France more than 700 years ago, or just try your tongue at Hebrew.

<http://www.assyrianlanguage.com>

Learn Aramaic, and you won't squint to see the subtitles in the movie *The Passion of The Christ*. Aramaic was spoken in ancient Turkey, Persia and Palestine.

Oriental Leanings

The Mandarin language dialect of Chinese is spoken the most in the world. If you're keen on mastering oriental languages, check these sites out:

<http://www.csulb.edu/~txie/ccol/content.htm>

Learn Mandarin, with more of an emphasis on spoken Mandarin, rather than written.

<http://www.japanese-online.com>

Here you can learn Japanese, and also culture pointers in terms of what to say when—the Japanese have a lot of traditions.

<http://korean.sogang.ac.kr>

This is an intensive five-week course that will also fetch you a certificate, complete with a seal of the Centre for Korean Studies at Sogang University. Signed by the director and everything!